Back Arrow & Forward Arrow - How They Work

Overview

The back (<-) and forward (->) buttons are NOT a general browser-style history. They are a one-step undo/redo specifically for the "Clear All" action.

They are disabled by default and only become active after the user clicks Clear All.

The Two State Variables

```
 let preClearSnapshot = null;  // filter/slicer state saved just before Clear All
let inClearedState   = false; // true = we are currently in the blank/cleared state
```

These two variables are the entire memory of the feature.

Step-by-Step Flow

1. User clicks "Clear All"

```
 preClearSnapshot = await snapshotCurrentState();  // snapshot saved here
inClearedState   = true;
updateNavButtons();   // back button becomes enabled
```

snapshotCurrentState() captures all report-level filters and all slicer selections across every visited page.

2. User clicks Back (<-)

```
 if (!preClearSnapshot || !inClearedState) { return; }  // guard

inClearedState = false;
updateNavButtons();              // disable back, enable forward
applyFilters(preClearSnapshot);  // restores pre-clear state
```

3. User clicks Forward (->)

```
 if (!preClearSnapshot || inClearedState) { return; }  // guard

inClearedState = true;
updateNavButtons();                              // enable back, disable forward
applyFilters({ filters: [], slicers: [] });      // re-applies blank/cleared state
```

Button Enable / Disable Logic

```
 function updateNavButtons() {
   back.disabled = !preClearSnapshot || !inClearedState;
   fwd.disabled  = !preClearSnapshot ||  inClearedState;
```

```
}
```

Situation	Back	Forward
Page just loaded	Off	Off
After Clear All	ON	Off
After clicking Back	Off	ON
After clicking Forward	ON	Off
After applying Saved View	Off	Off

Applying a saved view resets preClearSnapshot = null and inClearedState = false, disabling both buttons.

What applyFilters() Does

When called with the snapshot it:

- Sets report-level filters via the Power BI JS SDK
- Arms the slicer states so they are applied page-by-page as the user navigates
- Immediately applies slicers to the currently active page

Key File Locations (templates/index.html)

Lines 388-410	State variables + back/forward click handlers
Lines 391-396	updateNavButtons() - enable/disable logic
Lines 1063-1117	Clear All confirmation handler (snapshot taken here)
Lines 521-566	applyFilters() - restores or clears state
Lines 626-632	snapshotCurrentState() - captures filters + slicers

Summary: Back/Forward toggle between your last filter state and a blank slate -- they exist purely to undo/redo a "Clear All".